

Keepsake — Suggestions & Deviations

Ideas that differ from Design Bible v3, saved for your review

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How to read this

A running list of ideas, refinements, and **deviations from Design Bible v3** that came up while building the 2.5D prototype. Items marked **acted** were small, safe, or privacy/security-related and were applied during the build (also in the Work Log). Items marked **proposed** await your decision — nothing here has changed the product's direction on its own.

Acted on (small / safe / privacy)

acted Persist photographs locally

The Bible (§3) says the current prototype keeps images in memory and lets them disappear on refresh. For a testable prototype that felt wrong, so books (including photos, as downscaled data URLs) now persist in IndexedDB. Trivially reversible if you want the "ephemeral" behaviour back.

acted **privacy** Local visibility gating

Private books and the archive are hidden under visitor "View as" modes, and the book becomes read-only for visitors. This is a client-side *preview only* and is **not** real security — real enforcement must be server-side (§17). Called out clearly in the UI and Work Log so it is never mistaken for protection.

acted Downscale uploads

Uploaded images are resized to $\leq 1400\text{px}$ before storage to protect browser memory and IndexedDB quota (a risk noted in §6/§22).

acted Accessibility & small UX polish

Added `name / aria-label` to all form fields; a **Music volume** control; visitors see their own pending note. Follow-up pass: skip links, a `<main>` landmark, named icon buttons, object focus rings, Tab-trapped dialogs that restore focus, a live spread counter, and tour copy exposed in full to assistive tech (the typewriter is visual-only). A real-device VoiceOver/TalkBack pass is still worth doing later (§23).

Proposed (your call)

proposed Room art: painted 2.5D first, toon-3D later (and only if we miss it)

The room is still CSS gradients, Lucide icons, and a few textures. It holds as a prototype, but it is not yet the Little Big Planet / Sly Cooper / Edith Finch diorama the Bible asked for. The Messenger tour borrowed *layout* from messenger.abeto.co, not its cel-shaded WebGL look. Here is the art brief I would actually commission.

Recommendation

Stay 2.5D. Commission a set of painted, cut-out parallax plates and drop them into the existing depth rig. Do **not** rewrite the room in Three.js to chase Messenger's toon shader. A full 3D scene is a different product: heavier bundle, new camera language, and it fights the scrapbook-on-a-desk metaphor. Bible §8 already picked 2.5D for this reason.

What I want the room to look like

- **Little Big Planet** — objects feel sewn, stuffed, or paper-cut. Soft rim light. A slight “pop” when you hover (we already do this; the art should invite it).
- **Sly Cooper** — inked silhouettes, limited palette, storybook noir. Edges read from across the room. Night should go indigo + amber, not grey.
- **Edith Finch** — a lived-in house, slightly melancholy, dust in the beam, nothing sterile. Clutter that looks placed by a person, not a UI kit.

Palette already in the prototype: cocoa leather `#4a3224`, cream paper `#f3e9d8`, seal red `#b55245`, dusk mauve, night indigo. New art should lock to those, not invent a second brand.

Deliverables (phase 1 — illustrated plates)

Ask an illustrator for layered PNGs/WebPs with transparent cut-outs, authored at $\sim 2\times$ the scene size so they survive the existing pointer parallax:

1. **Far sky** — four plates: day, dusk, night, plus a weather overlay (rain streaks / snow) we can tint. The window already frames this.
2. **Back wall** — plaster + picture rail + window casing. Warm, slightly stained. No UI chrome painted in.
3. **Mid furniture** — bookshelf (empty bays; we keep drawing spines in CSS so book count stays live), framed timeline, cork map. These must match today's hotspot boxes in `lib/hotspots.ts`.
4. **Desk + cabinet + CRT** — wood grain, a lamp, the kettle, a tea ring already in the wood. The open book stays a live HTML cover (leather + title), not painted shut.
5. **Foreground clutter** — a few optional bits (pressed flower, ribbon, letter, loose photo) that the curator can show/hide. Same silhouette language as the mid layer.
6. **Season washes** — four multiply overlays (spring green, summer gold, autumn rust, winter blue) rather than four full rooms.

Technical constraints for the brief: 16:9 safe area; keep interactive objects inside the current percentage hitboxes; no baked-in text (we set titles in type); no photoreal PBR; export as premultiplied WebP, max ~ 400 KB per plate.

What I do *not* want (yet)

- A free-orbit 3D camera. The room is a tableau. Parallax is a glance, not a fly-through.
- A full Three.js rewrite of every object. That would freeze the scrapbook, notes, and curator into a 3D engine we do not need.
- Messenger's cool grey cel-shade as the house style. Keep cream, ink, and wood. If we ever toon-shade something, the outline colour should be cocoa, not black comic-ink.
- AI texture dumps or stock isometric rooms. The point is one hand. Same illustrator for every plate.

Optional later: one toon-3D hero, not a 3D house

If painted plates still feel flat after we live with them, the honest Messenger-like experiment is a *single* WebGL accent — probably the open book, or the window glass — sitting in the 2.5D scene:

- Toon/cel: a 3–4 stop ramp (`MeshToonMaterial` or a tiny custom shader), not a realistic light model.
- Ink outline via an inverted-hull or fullscreen Sobel; stroke in `#2c2418`, 1–2px.
- Paper/leather/wood as *painted* textures, not scanned PBR sets.
- Camera locked; only a few degrees of parallax, matching the CSS layers.
- Reduced-motion: freeze the mesh and show the still plate.

That is a spike, not a rewrite. If it does not obviously beat the painted book, throw it away. I would not start there.

Commission shape

One illustrator (or a very small studio), two rounds: greyscale layups against a screenshot of the current room, then colour. Style frames: a LBP sack-person living room, a Sly Cooper hideout interior, Edith Finch's kitchen at dusk. Payment for plates + a year of seasonal variants. We keep hotspot code, tour, and curator as-is.

acted Music: ambient pad + Spotify account login

The CRT is now a provider adapter (§13): an offline generative Web-Audio pad by default, plus a "Connect Spotify" login via browser-safe OAuth PKCE (no client secret). Once connected it can browse your playlists and set one per book; an embedded player handles playback. *Needs your input to go live:* the Client ID can come from

`VITE_SPOTIFY_CLIENT_ID` / `SPOTIFY_CLIENT_ID`, or be pasted once in the CRT panel (stored only in this browser). Register the exact Redirect URI shown in the panel. The Client Secret is **not** used and must never be prefixed with `VITE_`. Full in-app playback control (vs. the embed/previews) requires Spotify Premium (Web Playback SDK) — a natural next step once credentials exist. Licensed offline lo-fi tracks remain a later option per the Bible.

proposed Export: browser print now, print pipeline later

Export uses the browser's Print / Save-as-PDF. A production path (§25) needs a server PDF renderer with bleed, trim, safe zones, and low-resolution warnings before any print-on-demand vendor.

acted Achievements event ledger

Reworked to match §12: a pure rules engine derives completion from state (idempotent, reproducible grants), each unlock is stamped with a completion time, and a "seen" flag separates completion from reward presentation. Added a few more achievements (storyteller, decorator, collector). Next step is persisting a fuller immutable action ledger once a backend exists.

acted Curated-RNG opportunity queue + expanded catalogue

Replaced the single teaser with a real queue (§20): candidates carry eligibility + priority + cooldown; a curator selects at most one per session and records a persisted receipt so cooldowns hold across sessions. The *welcome* candidate starts the guided room tour until `progress.completedTour` is set. The catalogue is now sixteen kinds: welcome, reward, empty-page, whisper, photo-out, ajar-book, bookmark, guest-wave, map-glint, night-moth, pressed-flower, season-note, letter, window-draft, kettle, tea-ring. Quiet events (priority

< 25) have a 35% chance of presenting nothing, so the room can stay still. Force one in QA with `?event=<kind>`.

acted Messenger-style first-visit dialogue

You asked to borrow the bottom-of-scene text-bubble layout from messenger.abeto.co for a first-login walkthrough. Implemented as a paper/ink dialogue (name plate overlapping top-left, offset block shadow, square next control overlapping bottom-right) with a spotlight that follows each room object. This is a deviation from Bible §21 “discovery over instruction” — taken because you asked for it, and kept skippable / house-voiced so it can still be ignored. The cel-shaded 3D look of Messenger itself (toon shading, ink outlines, WebGL scene) is *not* copied here; that remains the proposed illustrated-parallax upgrade above.

proposed Stickers & craft assets

Stickers are emoji glyphs for now. Replace with licensed SVG/WebP sticker packs and scrapbook styles (§11), keeping the same transformable-element model already in place.

proposed Map stays abstract / manual

The atlas is an illustrated, non-geocoded map; pins are placed manually. This actually matches the Bible's privacy stance (approximate/manual by default, §16) — I'd keep it and make exact coordinates strictly opt-in if geocoding is ever added.

proposed Single IndexedDB record

For prototype simplicity all state is one record. Production should split per entity and move to a server (Postgres per §4) — expected, not a concern yet.

proposed Small polish backlog

- acted** First-visit onboarding is now a Messenger-style room tour (name plate, paper dialogue box, overlapping next, spotlight on each object) instead of a single banner. Requested; skippable; replayable from settings. See the work log.
- acted** Tidied the map "pin a memory" form (labelled fields, cleaner layout, disabled-until-valid).
- acted** Modals close on `Escape`, trap `Tab`, restore focus, and carry `role="dialog" / aria-modal`.
- acted** Page-turn leaf now shows the real incoming spread on the back face (not blank paper), plus a short Web Audio rustle/slap. Reduced-motion still swaps instantly and stays silent.
- acted** Editor undo/redo (`chips + ⌘Z / Ctrl+Z`, `⌘⇧Z / Ctrl+Y`) and a `?` shortcut list.
- acted** First keyboard/screen-reader pass: skip links, a page `<main>`, named icon buttons, object focus rings, live spread counter, tour text exposed in full to AT (typewriter

is visual-only). A real-device VoiceOver/TalkBack pass is still worth doing later (§23).

proposed **Future: Kindle / Amazon library on the bookshelf**

A later update, not this prototype. Let someone connect their **Amazon library or Kindle** so the room bookshelf can also show books they are reading or have already read — real titles as spines, sitting beside the scrapbooks they make. When a friend is looking at that shelf, they could start a conversation through the existing **notes** and **guestbook** (a remark on a spine, a signed page in the guest book), instead of inventing a second comment system.

Why it fits

- The shelf is already a place you stand and look. Imported spines would use the same tug / title / arrange language as scrapbooks, marked as *from the library* so they are not mistaken for a book you authored here.
- Notes already attach to a book; the guestbook already belongs to the room. A friend visiting a shelf could leave a note on *the coast* they both read, or sign the book after browsing. Visibility stays the private / friends / public split we already preview (§17).
- Reading state (reading / read / abandoned) is a natural badge on the spine, not a new wall.

Constraints to settle before building

- **Amazon does not offer a public, Spotify-like Kindle library API.** Any connection would need an official partner path, a user-exported library file, or a different catalogue (e.g. a manual shelf, or another service that *does* grant read-only library access). Do not scrape Amazon or Kindle Cloud Reader.
- Imported titles are metadata (title, author, cover if licensed, reading state) — *not* the ebook file, and not a reader inside Keepsake. Opening a library spine should open a discussion surface (notes / guestbook), not the book's pages.
- Opt-in, revocable, and per-title visibility. A connected library must not dump every purchase onto a public shelf. Same privacy stance as the map: approximate and chosen, never a silent leak of what someone bought (§16).
- Needs a real account and a backend. The current IndexedDB “View as” preview cannot host a friend standing in your room.

Worth keeping on the list. Do not start it until scrapbook spines, notes, and visiting a friend's room are real — this idea sits on top of those, it does not replace them.